MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検2級
リーディングトレーニング

第8回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検2級形式のリーディング第8回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) To prevent coastal erosion, volunteers planted deep-rooted grasses that (　　) shifting sand dunes.

1 stabilize　**2** sterilize　**3** symbolize　**4** summarize

(2) The city archive allows citizens to inspect nineteenth-century town maps, (　　) by appointment only.

1 astride　**2** amidst　**3** albeit　**4** aboard

(3) Because the ferry engine vibrated loudly, passengers in the rear lounge had to raise their voices to make themselves (　　).

1 hear　**2** heard　**3** hearing　**4** to hear

(4) The mountain clinic operates (　　) solar panels and a small hydroelectric turbine throughout the year.

1 in collision with　**2** in defiance of　**3** at the mercy of　**4** by virtue of

(5) Many first-time pottery students underestimate how much clay (　　) as water evaporates in the kiln.

1 shrinks　**2** shrugs　**3** shreds　**4** shines

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) Even a minor typo in a computer command can render an entire automated script ( ).

1 restless **2** useless **3** countless **4** effortless

(7) After three dry summers in a row, town officials imposed temporary ( ) on lawn watering and car washing.

1 clues **2** cures **3** curbs **4** crops

(8) Little ( ) the brothers suspect that the dusty violin in their attic had been crafted in Cremona.

1 would **2** had **3** were **4** did

(9) Because neonatal patients are highly ( ) to sudden drafts, incubator doors open through small hand ports.

1 substantial **2** sustainable **3** susceptible **4** subordinate

(10) The town's lantern festival was scaled back this autumn so as not to ( ) local volunteer firefighters.

1 overburden **2** overhear **3** overthrow **4** overrule

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(11) Both towns agreed to share snowplow crews across the municipal border for their (　　) benefit.

1 manual　**2** mutual　**3** mental　**4** minimal

(12) When repainting an old wooden boat, scraping off loose flakes first is (　　) if the new coat is to stick.

1 inaccurate　**2** indifferent　**3** inaudible　**4** indispensable

(13) Rather than tear down the closed elementary school, residents proposed (　　) its classrooms for elderly day care and craft studios.

1 repurposing　**2** reproducing　**3** repressing　**4** reproaching

(14) The hiking map is printed on synthetic waterproof paper that resists tearing even when (　　) soaked.

1 theoretically　**2** thoughtfully　**3** thankfully　**4** thoroughly

(15) During her internship at the botanical garden, Aya helped (　　) handwritten seed records from the 1950s into a searchable database.

1 compel　**2** comply　**3** compile　**4** compete

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(16) No matter how advanced autopilot sensors become, maritime law requires a qualified officer to remain on (　　) on the bridge.

1 ward　**2** watch　**3** wave　**4** wake

(17) Having never lived north of Tokyo, Takumi was taken (　　) by how early the sun set in Sapporo in December.

1 aback　**2** aside　**3** apart　**4** ashore

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Supermarkets Place Bakeries and Flowers Near the Entrance

Step through the automatic doors of many large supermarkets, and instead of canned soup or laundry detergent, you are greeted by buckets of seasonal flowers and the warm scent of baking bread. Retail planners rarely leave store layouts to chance, and dedicating prime entrance floor space to fragile petals and ovens reflects decades of consumer psychology research.

Shoppers arriving from busy streets or parking lots carry mental haste; people walking briskly tend to grab only the three items on their list and head straight for the register. Bright colors and the aroma of fresh crust trigger sensory associations with freshness and home cooking, prompting visitors to slow their pace and browse more attentively. (18), customers judge the quality of the entire store—including packaged goods aisles farther back—more favorably when their first impression feels vibrant and farm-fresh.

Practical handling plays a role in flower placement, though bread and produce require careful cart choreography too. Soft berries and bouquets get crushed if piled beneath milk cartons and canned tomatoes at the end of a trip. Placing delicate items in the upper child-seat basket right at the start keeps them safe, or reminds shoppers to pick up a bouquet on their way out. (19), checkout lanes are stocked with small impulse treats at eye level while people wait.

Understanding store geography helps everyday consumers enjoy pleasant displays while (20).

(18)

1 On the contrary
2 Otherwise
3 Moreover
4 Regardless

(19)

1 Despite this
2 In a similar vein
3 By accident
4 Until then

(20)

1 putting heavy milk cartons on top of soft strawberries
2 refusing to buy bread or vegetables at any grocery store
3 running through automatic doors at maximum speed
4 making more deliberate choices about what goes into their basket

How Salt Marshes Protect Coasts and Store Carbon

For much of the nineteenth and twentieth centuries, tidal salt marshes—low coastal grasslands flooded twice daily by seawater—were dismissed by planners as muddy wasteland. Across Europe, East Asia, and North America, thousands of hectares were drained behind dikes to create pasture, factory sites, or port landfills.

Only after costly storm surges battered reclaimed shorelines did engineers measure what had been lost. Dense mats of salt-tolerant cordgrass and rushes act like a giant natural sponge and brake: friction from millions of flexible stems slows incoming storm waves and lowers flood peaks before water reaches inland homes. Unlike rigid concrete walls, healthy marshes trap river sediment on every tide, allowing the ground surface to build upward gradually over decades. (21), coastal towns behind wide marshes often spend far less on seawall repairs.

Climate researchers uncovered a second superpower hidden in the mud below. On land, fallen forest leaves decompose in oxygen-rich soil and release most of their carbon back into the air within years. Waterlogged marsh mud contains almost no oxygen, however, slowing microbial decay to a crawl. Dead marsh roots accumulate in thick peat layers meters deep, locking carbon away for centuries—a process scientists call "blue carbon." (22), restoring breached dikes to let tides return revives nursery habitats for young flounder and crabs.

Protecting surviving tidal marshes is therefore no luxury; it represents (23).

(21)

1 As a result
2 On the contrary
3 Otherwise
4 Nevertheless

(22)

1 Instead
2 At the same time
3 Conversely
4 In vain

(23)

1 proof that concrete dikes never require maintenance
2 a plan to turn every inland forest into salty mud
3 a practical investment in flood defense, fisheries, and climate stability
4 a way to speed up microbial decay in coastal soil

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Notice Regarding Shared Bicycle Permits on Campus

From: Campus Traffic & Safety Office
To: All Commuting Students
Subject: New reflector inspection and abandoned-bike tags starting May 1

Dear commuting students,
With more than 1,400 bicycles using the North and West campus racks daily, rack shortages and evening near-misses at the main slope have increased this spring. Starting May 1, the Campus Traffic Office is updating registration rules for all 2026–2027 bicycle permits.

To receive your blue 2026 sticker, bring your bicycle in person to the East Gate booth between April 20 and April 30 (12:10 p.m. – 1:00 p.m. or 4:15 p.m. – 5:30 p.m.). Staff will check three items before issuing a sticker: working front headlights, a rear red reflector or tail lamp, and an audible bell. Online applications alone will no longer be accepted, as many registered bikes lacked working lights last winter.

In addition, bicycles parked without a valid 2026 sticker—or left unmoved in the same rack space for over thirty days—will receive a yellow warning tag on May 11. Tagged bicycles not claimed within fourteen days will be moved to the South Storage Lot.

Thank you for helping keep campus paths safe,
Campus Traffic & Safety Office

Notice Regarding Shared Bicycle Permits on Campus — Questions

(24) Why will the Campus Traffic Office no longer accept online-only permit applications?

1 The university website shut down permanently.

2 Blue stickers must be painted directly onto tires by hand.

3 Only twenty students ride bicycles to campus.

4 Many registered bicycles last winter did not actually have working lights, so staff now inspect bikes in person.

(25) Which three items will staff inspect at the East Gate booth?

1 Helmet color, tire brand, and basket size.

2 Student grades, library fines, and club membership.

3 Front headlights, rear red reflector or tail lamp, and an audible bell.

4 Pedal weight, saddle height, and frame paint.

(26) What happens if a bicycle receives a yellow warning tag on May 11 and nobody claims it for two weeks?

1 It is moved to the South Storage Lot after fourteen days.

2 It is locked permanently to the North rack.

3 It is donated immediately on May 12.

4 The owner receives a free new headlight.

Why Pianists Watch Humidity More Than Temperature

Walk backstage at a symphony hall, and you may spot a small digital hygrometer sitting right beside the grand piano. Audience members naturally notice whether a hall feels warm or chilly, yet piano technicians worry far more about relative humidity—the percentage of moisture held in the air. Keeping an acoustic piano in tune and responsive depends above all on protecting its wooden heart: the soundboard.

Beneath a grand piano's heavy cast-iron frame and steel strings—which pull with nearly twenty tons of combined tension—stretches a thin, slightly arched sheet of Sitka spruce called the soundboard. Strings alone move very little air; they rely on wooden bridges pressed against that arched spruce board to amplify vibrations into rich musical tone. Because wood is hygroscopic, its cells swell when indoor air is humid in summer and shrink when winter heating dries the hall.

As the soundboard swells in damp July air, its upward arch pushes harder against the strings, stretching them tighter and raising the piano's pitch noticeably—especially in the middle register. Conversely, dry January air flattens the arch slightly, letting string tension drop so notes go flat and lose warmth. Repeated swings between eighty percent summer humidity and twenty percent winter dryness can eventually split the spruce seams or loosen the thousands of wooden pins holding the strings.

Major concert venues therefore invest heavily in climate-controlled "piano garages" backstage, maintaining relative humidity close to forty-five percent year-round. Where full building humidification is impractical—such as in historic stone churches or school auditoriums—technicians mount slender climate systems directly underneath the piano belly: a low-wattage warming rod gently dries damp summer air, while a wick reservoir adds moisture in winter.

A pianist's artistry begins at the keys, yet the stability of every chord rests quietly on keeping centuries-old wood science in balance.

Why Pianists Watch Humidity More Than Temperature — Questions

(27) What role does the spruce soundboard play inside a grand piano?

1 It holds the pianist's sheet music at eye level.

2 It amplifies the vibrations of the strings into full musical tone.

3 It cools the cast-iron frame with electric fans.

4 It replaces steel strings in modern concert pianos.

(28) Why does a piano's pitch tend to rise during humid summer weather?

1 Pianists strike the keys harder in July.

2 Steel strings shrink to half their length when damp.

3 Stage spotlights melt the tuning pins.

4 Moisture makes the wooden soundboard swell upward, pushing harder against the strings and increasing tension.

(29) What long-term structural damage can extreme seasonal swings in humidity cause?

1 Spruce soundboard seams may crack and wooden tuning pins can loosen.

2 The cast-iron frame turns into soft copper.

3 Black keys lose their color in sunlight.

4 Foot pedals detach during concerts.

(30) How do technicians protect pianos in buildings like historic churches or school auditoriums where full-hall climate control is difficult?

1 By submerging the piano in water every January.

2 By tuning the strings only once every ten years.

3 By removing the soundboard before every winter concert.

4 By installing compact warming and humidifying devices directly beneath the piano.

(31) What relative humidity level do major concert venues typically aim to keep in backstage piano storage?

1 Around five percent.

2 Exactly ninety-five percent.

3 Close to forty-five percent.

4 Zero percent in winter and one hundred percent in summer.